asking questions, looking for you. It could cause problems. And don't you want André to live free of guilt? Or do you want him haunted by the belief that he left you behind?"

She hesitated. There was a ring of truth to what he said. André would not give her up easily, especially after she'd saved his life by arranging for him to leave Berlin. "But how will we ensure he joins Léa and me and Josef when we flee?" Her voice tightened a little. "If he thinks I no longer love him, maybe he won't come."

"Leave that to me." He reached into the desk and pulled out a paper. "I'd like you to sign this." He handed it to her, along with a pen.

She read the word at the top: *Heiratsurkunde*, Marriage Certificate. And then her name at the bottom pressed next to his. The pit of her stomach dropped. She looked up—he watched her.

"What are you waiting for?" he asked, an edge in his voice. "You still don't trust me?"

She had agreed to marry him and carried his ring in her pocket like an anchor weighing her down. But to sign the paper that gave her life away was final. Last night, talking with Léa reminded her of the times in the boardinghouse when they'd shared everything. Léa had been probing her about the ring intermittently, ever since she'd set eyes on it. Rose had stuck to her story that she'd found it, but yesterday she had almost told Léa the truth. If she did, maybe her sister would help her find a way out.

Had Reinhardt sensed her hesitation? She held the paper in her hand. One signature, and then he owned her. She wouldn't be able to change her mind. He flexed his fingers and she noticed the individual veins on his hands, the way his white cuffs rimmed the gray wool uniform.

"Go on. Time is running short. There's much I need to prepare for your sister and us. Show me that I can trust you." His voice held a warning.

Rose had come this far; how could she turn back? There was Katya, Nadiya's baby, to bring to safety. *Be strong.* It was the right thing to do. If anyone could protect them against the Soviet army heading their way, it was Reinhardt. She lifted the pen and signed.

Now in the barracks, Rose heard voices outside. Katya had fallen asleep on her chest, and she returned her to the basket and got up and went to the window. A sliver of light appeared at the edge of the sky. On the road that ran in front of the barracks, she could make out three people huddling